# ECO 112: Principles of Macroeconomics

Syllabus, Fall 2026

**Class times:** Tuesdays & Thursdays 2:00-3:30 PM
**Location:** Hagfors Center 151
**Instructor:** Matthew Braaksma
**Department:** Department of Business and Economics
**Email:** braaksma@augsburg.edu
**Office Hours:** Tuesdays & Thursdays 3:30-4:30 PM, Hagfors Center 323

## Course Overview

ECO 112 introduces you to macroeconomics: the study of modern economies at a national level. We'll focus on national income accounts, monetary and fiscal policy, and economic growth. By the end of the course, you should be able to apply these concepts to analyze national economies, engage in policy debates, and follow international economic events with real understanding.

## Required Materials

The textbook for this course is McConnell, Brue, and Flynn, *Macroeconomics*, 2026 Release, McGraw Hill Education.

The electronic edition is required through McGraw Hill Connect; a print copy is optional.

1. Obtain your Connect access code from the bookstore or directly from McGraw Hill. A short-term courtesy access period is available, but you'll need to upgrade to a full access code once it expires.
2. Register for Connect through our Moodle page. The Connect Student Registration sheet with instructions is posted there.
3. Once registered, your code gives you access to the e-book, SmartBook readings, and homework for this course.

Additional readings and current-events materials will be posted on Moodle throughout the semester.

## How This Course Runs

We meet Tuesdays and Thursdays. Each class follows a consistent rhythm:

- **Tuesday:** Homework/quiz due on the previous chapter, then lecture on a new chapter.
- **Thursday:** Student presentation on the previous chapter (once presentations begin, see below), then lecture continues on that week's new material.

**Reading (SmartBook):** You are expected to complete the SmartBook reading for each chapter before its Tuesday lecture. This is not separately graded, but it is the difference between a lecture that is new to you and one that reinforces what you already encountered.

## Grading

| Category | Points | % of Grade |
|---|---|---|
| Exam 1 | 150 | 25% |
| Exam 2 | 150 | 25% |
| Presentation | 120 | 20% |
| Connect Homework | 120 | 20% |
| Quizzes | 60 | 10% |
| **Total** | **600** | **100%** |

### Connect Homework

Homework is assigned through Connect, tied directly to each chapter. You will have two attempts for each assignment; your second score incurs a 15% penalty.

- Homework is due Tuesdays (see the full schedule for exact dates).
- Late homework is penalized 20% per day late.
- One assignment score is dropped from your final tally at the end of the semester.

### Quizzes

Quizzes are short, paper, in-class checks of understanding. They are intentionally low-stakes (10% of your grade): the goal is a quick check on whether the core ideas landed, not a high-pressure assessment.

- Your two lowest quiz scores are dropped.
- No makeup quizzes; a missed quiz counts as one of your drops (up to two).

### Presentations

Starting in midway through the semester (Chapter 7: National Income), small groups will present a current-events article or video connected to that week's chapter, along with discussion questions to lead the class. Details on the presentation schedule, grading rubric, and expectations will be posted on Moodle.

### Exams

There are two exams, each covering only the material since the previous exam (not cumulative):

- **Exam 1**: covers Chapters 1, 2, 3, 6, 7, 8, 9
- **Exam 2**: covers Chapters 10–17

Bring a pencil and calculator; no cell phones during exams. If you leave the room during an exam, it counts as submitted. Makeup exams are only available for a documented extenuating circumstance or a conflicting school event. Contact the instructor as soon as you know there is an issue, not after the fact.

## Use of Generative AI

Generative AI may be used in this course only as permitted below or in individual assignment instructions. When AI use is permitted, you remain responsible for the accuracy, quality, originality, and appropriateness of everything you submit. Any substantive use of AI should be disclosed, including the tool used and how it contributed to the work. Do not enter confidential, private, or proprietary information into an AI system. Assignment-specific instructions take precedence over this general policy where they differ.

| Category | Policy | Rationale |
|---|---|---|
| Quizzes & Exams | **Red**: no AI use | Closed-book, in-person assessments by design. |
| Connect Homework | **Yellow**: AI can support your process, not replace your understanding | Homework is low-stakes practice, not the primary test of knowledge. |
| Presentations | **Yellow**: AI is fine for finding articles or brainstorming, not for writing your analysis | The real test happens live, fielding questions in front of the class. |

## Attendance

*Required by the School of Business, Department of Business and Economics Attendance Policy:*

> The Department of Business and Economics believes that regular attendance is essential for students to develop a thorough understanding of course content. Students who miss more than 30% of scheduled class meetings in a semester-long course will automatically receive a failing grade (F). In a Tuesday/Thursday course, missing more than 8 classes will result in an automatic F. You must have full access to the CONNECT homework website by the fourth week of the semester; if not, you will be asked to withdraw. Students who believe they qualify for an exception due to extraordinary personal circumstances must obtain approval from both the instructor and the Department Chair.

Given the quiz drop policy above, occasional absences are already built into your grade. Use those drops for illness or emergencies rather than assuming a makeup will be available.

## Grading Standards

The course follows the Augsburg University grading scale.

| Letter Grade | Numerical Grade | % Grade | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| A | 4.00 | 93–100 | Excellent: Achieves highest standards of excellence |
| A- | 3.67 | 90–92 | |
| B+ | 3.33 | 88–89 | |
| B | 3.00 | 83–87 | Good: Achieves above basic course standards |
| B- | 2.67 | 80–82 | |
| C+ | 2.33 | 78–79 | |
| C | 2.00 | 73–77 | Satisfactory: Meets basic standards for the course |
| C- | 1.67 | 70–72 | |
| D+ | 1.33 | 68–69 | |
| D | 1.00 | 63–67 | Poor: Performance below basic course standards |
| D- | 0.67 | 60–62 | |
| F | 0.00 | <60 | Unsatisfactory: work either completed at a level not worthy of credit, or not completed |

## Course Outline

The full week-by-week schedule, including exact dates, homework due dates, quiz dates, and presentation assignments, is posted on Moodle. In brief, the course covers:

Ch 1 Choices; Ch 2 Market System; Ch 3 Supply, Demand, Equilibrium; Ch 6 Intro to Macroeconomics; Ch 7 National Income; Ch 8 Economic Growth; Ch 9 Business Cycles, Unemployment, Inflation; **Exam 1**; Ch 10 Basic Macroeconomic Relationships; Ch 11 Aggregate Expenditure Model; Ch 12 Aggregate Demand & Supply; Ch 13 Fiscal Policy; Ch 14–15 Money, Banking

& Monetary Policy; Ch 16–17 Interest Rates & Financial Economics; Trade & the Environment; **Exam 2** (Finals Week).

This outline is tentative and subject to change; check Moodle regularly for updates.

## University Policies, Student Rights, and Classroom Responsibilities

### Academic Integrity

You must follow the Augsburg University Student Conduct Code at all times. Academic dishonesty, including plagiarism, will result in a zero on the assignment and may lead to further disciplinary action. If you are unsure what constitutes plagiarism or acceptable AI use under this syllabus, ask before submitting, not after.

### FERPA and Privacy

In order to create a classroom community built on trust, all interactions, discussions, and course activities must remain private and free from external intrusion. The university protects your privacy by using only university-approved course technologies and adhering to the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA). We do not share personally identifiable information without your written consent, except for legitimate educational purposes or as required by law.

**Peer-to-peer privacy:** Do not share other students' personal information, work, or classroom discussion outside this course without their explicit consent. Do not photograph, record, or share representations of other students' work or presentations to social media or any other third party.

### Title IX

Augsburg University is committed to creating a safe learning environment free of sexual misconduct. If you or someone you know has experienced sexual misconduct, you may contact the Dean of Students & Title IX Coordinator at titleix@augsburg.edu or 612-330-1499 to report an incident, seek support, or take action.

Faculty members are required to disclose information about suspected or alleged sexual misconduct to the Title IX Coordinator. If you would prefer to speak with a confidential resource instead, you may contact the Center for Wellness and Counseling (cwc@augsburg.edu, 612-330-1707), Campus Ministry (612-330-1732), or the Aurora Center (aurora@umn.edu, 612-626-9111, 24/7).

### Special Accommodations

Augsburg is committed to providing equal access to the academic experience for all students. If you have, or think you may have, a disability, contact the CLASS Office at 612-330-1053 or visit augsburg.edu/class to arrange a confidential discussion about accommodations. If you are

already registered with CLASS Office, please let the instructor know early in the semester so accommodations can be arranged for this course.

**Non-Discrimination**

Augsburg University recognizes that our differences deepen our understanding of one another and the world, rather than dividing us. This classroom welcomes students of all races, ethnicities, gender identities, sexual orientations, religions, and backgrounds. If you feel isolated or face barriers to inclusion, please speak with the instructor early in the semester.

**Tutoring Center**

Your tuition provides free access to academic support resources, including peer tutoring through Knack, drop-in tutoring, and the Writing Center.

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*This syllabus is subject to change. Announcements about due dates, schedule changes, or policy updates will be made in class and posted on Moodle; you are responsible for staying current with both.*